

Dilly the Duckling's Soft Quack

An original bedtime story for ages 4–7. Reading time: about 4 minutes.



Kids Book Videos



Dilly was the smallest duckling in the pond. Her brothers and sisters quacked very loud. QUACK QUACK QUACK! They quacked at the sunrise. They quacked at the dragonflies. But when Dilly tried to quack, only a squeak came out. "Squeak," said Dilly. She tried again. "Squeak." Dilly felt embarrassed. Her face felt hot. "I cannot quack like everyone else," she said. She hid behind a lily pad. She did not want to try anymore.



Her friend Bram the beaver swam over. Bram was building a stick dam. He heard Dilly's tiny squeak. "What a sweet sound!" said Bram. Dilly shook her head. "It is too small," she said. "It is not a real quack." Dilly felt sad. Big tears wobbled in her eyes. Bram sat beside her. "Listen to my tail," said Bram. He slapped the water softly. Plip. "Not every sound has to be big," said Bram. "A soft quack is still a quack." "A soft quack is still a quack." Dilly repeated it quietly. "A soft quack is still a quack." It became her brave little saying.



Dilly lifted her beak. She let out her small sound. "Squeak quack," said Dilly. Bram clapped his paws. "Beautiful!" he cheered. Dilly tried again, a little braver. "Squeak quack! Squeak quack!" The dragonflies danced to her sound. The tadpoles wiggled with joy. Dilly felt proud. She felt light as a feather. Her small quack was special.



Can you make a soft quack like Dilly? Try it: squeak quack! Now a little louder: squeak quack! Dilly led a parade around the pond. Bram marched behind her. Her brothers and sisters joined in. They quacked loud, and Dilly quacked soft. Together it sounded like music. QUACK squeak QUACK squeak. Everyone smiled.



When the sun set, Dilly felt tired and happy. She tucked herself under her mother's wing. Bram floated nearby on a log. "Goodnight, sweet quacker," he whispered. Dilly gave one last tiny quack. "Squeak quack," she yawned. The pond grew quiet and still. And Dilly slept, soft and safe.

***Moral:** Your own small voice is just right the way it is.*

The End